

Literature • Realistic

Grade	1	Word Count	205
Lexile	490L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level H		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

We love our families, but they can drive us crazy. In **Brother Messy, Brother Neat**, two brothers are as different as they can be. One likes everything neat and tidy, and the other prefers creative messes. What happens when they are forced to share a room? Students will eagerly read to find out.


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Brother Messy, Brother Neat



Written by Torran Anderson
Illustrated by Norm Grock

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Focus Question

What is the problem, and how
do Pablo and Nico solve it?





Pablo was messy.
He liked to draw whenever
he could.



Nico was neat.
He liked to organize whatever
he could.



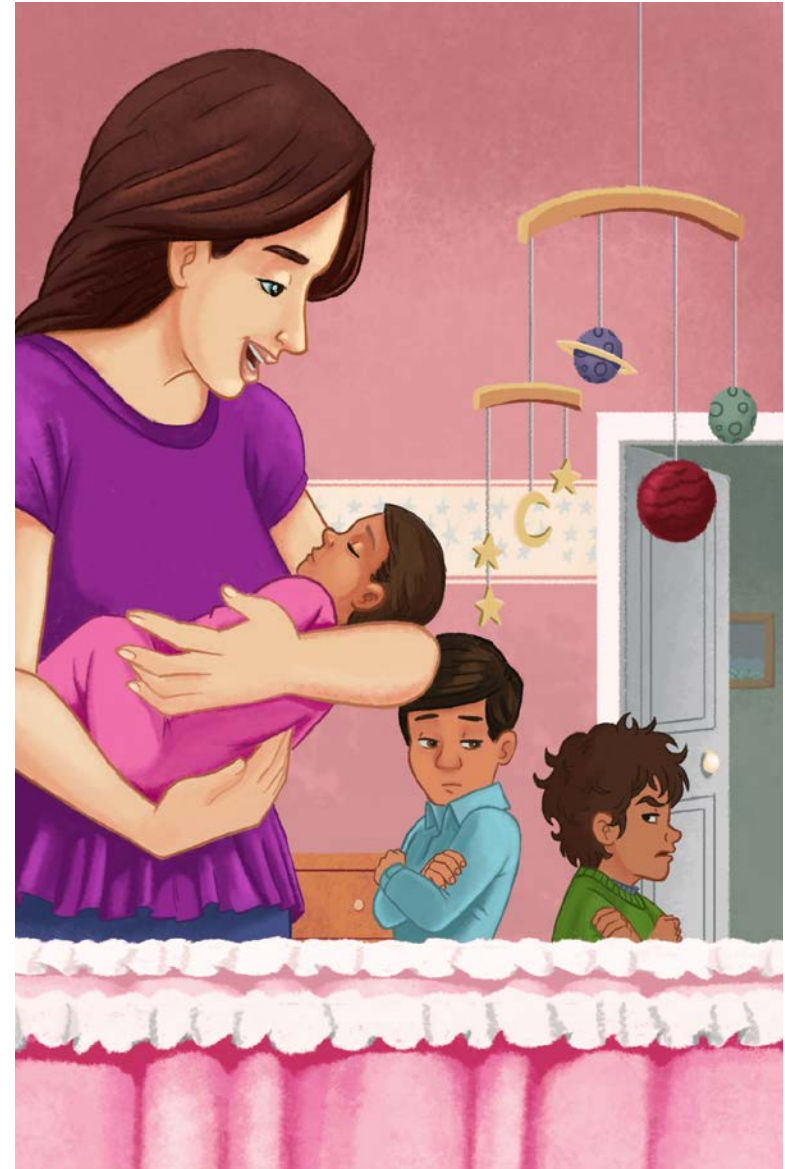
When their sister Maria was born, the boys had to share a room.



“I’m not sharing a room with that slob,” Nico said.



“How can I do anything fun when everything is so clean?” Pablo asked.



“Find a way to work it out,” their mother said.



Their first week together, Pablo
slept in the closet.
“It’s too clean out there,” Pablo said.



The closet was too dark at night,
though.
Pablo moved back into their room.



The second week, Nico put tape on the floor.

“You stay on your side,” Nico said.



Nico had to cross the line every day to leave the room, though.

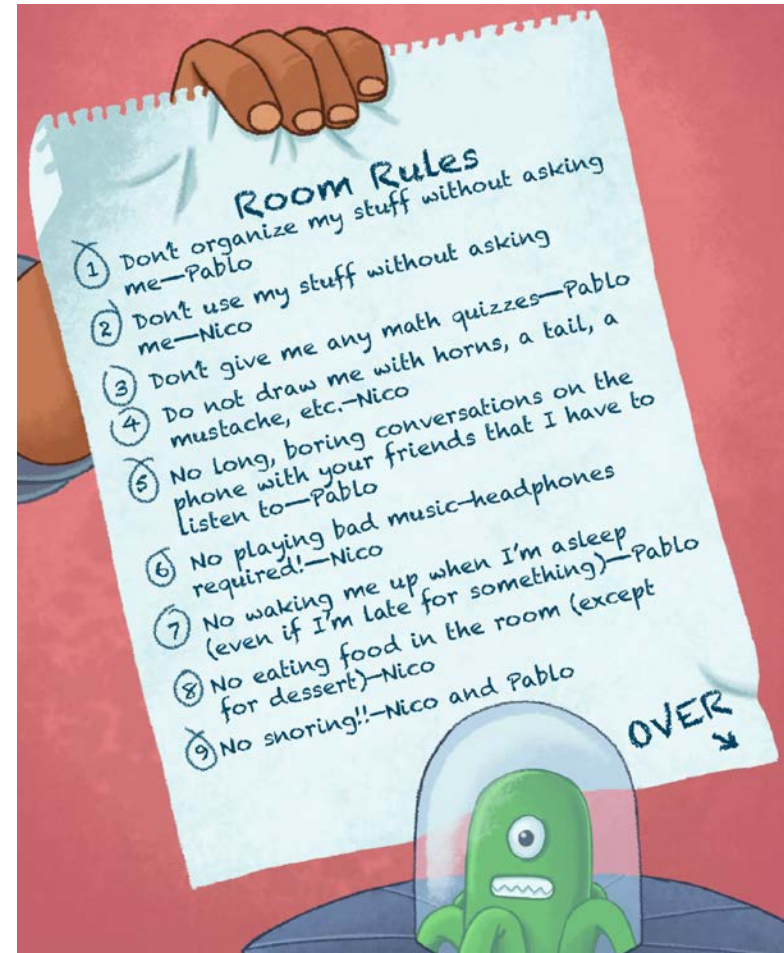
He pulled up the tape.



The third week, they decided to come up with rules.

“First rule is you can’t organize my stuff without asking me,” Pablo said.

“Second rule is you can’t use my stuff without asking *me*,” Nico said.



They thought up a list of fifteen rules they promised they wouldn't break.

At the end they both agreed on one more thing.



“We need to paint our room!”



Lucky for them, they both agreed on what to paint.